JANUARY 2026

Current Affairs

94 Multiple-Choice Questions with Answers & Explanations

For UPSC, SSC, Banking, Railways, Defence, State PSC and other government exams

Section	Questions
1. National News	9
2. International News	10
3. Government Schemes, Policy & Economy	14
4. Government Appointments	5
5. Awards & Honours	7
6. Important Reports, Rankings & Indexes	4
7. Sports	8
8. Defence	3
9. Science & Technology, Space, ISRO, DRDO & Discoveries	9
10. IMD, Climate & Environment	5
11. Summits & International Organisations	3
12. Important Days	7
13. Books & Authors	2
14. Obituaries	3
15. Important Personalities	5
Total	**94**

Scope: events dated 1-31 January 2026. Events falling just after the month (e.g. Union Budget on 1 Feb, Australian Open men's final, U-19 World Cup final) are deliberately excluded.

Month at a Glance - January 2026 Timeline

Date	Key events
1 Jan	Bulgaria adopts the euro (21st Eurozone member); IMD releases 2025 climate statement (8th warmest year)
3 Jan	US 'Operation Absolute Resolve' captures Venezuela's President Maduro
5 Jan	Delcy Rodriguez sworn in as acting president of Venezuela; Hubble 'Cloud-9' announced
7 Jan	MoSPI First Advance Estimates: FY26 GDP 7.4%; ecologist Madhav Gadgil dies
8-11 Jan	Somnath Swabhiman Parv (1,000 years since 1026 attack)
9 Jan	DRDL 12+ minute scramjet combustor ground test
9-12 Jan	Viksit Bharat Young Leaders Dialogue 2026
11 Jan	Kohli becomes 2nd-highest international run-scorer; 83rd Golden Globes; MPATGM test
12 Jan	ISRO PSLV-C62 / EOS-N1 fails (PS3 anomaly)
12-13 Jan	German Chancellor Merz visits India
14 Jan	WEF Global Risks Report 2026; BSF and ITBP DGs appointed
15 Jan	78th Army Day (Jaipur); IMD 151st Foundation Day; Crew-11 splashdown; NIA DG Rakesh Aggarwal
16 Jan	National Startup Day - 10 years of Startup India
19 Jan	UAE President visits India; Saina Nehwal confirms retirement
19-23 Jan	WEF Davos 2026 - 'A Spirit of Dialogue'
20 Jan	Nitin Nabin takes charge as BJP national president
21 Jan	Cabinet extends Atal Pension Yojana to 2030-31
22 Jan	US formally exits WHO; Board of Peace charter signed at Davos
24 Jan	ICC replaces Bangladesh with Scotland in T20 World Cup
25 Jan	Padma Awards 2026 and gallantry awards announced; 16th National Voters' Day
26 Jan	77th Republic Day (150 years of Vande Mataram); WPL's first century (Sciver-Brunt)
27 Jan	India-EU FTA concluded; Solid Waste Management Rules 2026 notified
28 Jan	Budget Session begins; Ajit Pawar dies in Baramati plane crash
29 Jan	Economic Survey 2025-26; SC stays UGC Equity Regulations 2026; EU lists IRGC as terrorist body
31 Jan	Sunetra Pawar sworn in as Deputy CM; Rybakina wins Australian Open; India win T20I series 4-1

1. National News

Q1. What was the central theme of the 77th Republic Day parade held at Kartavya Path on 26 January 2026?

(A) Viksit Bharat @2047
(B) 150 Years of Vande Mataram
(C) Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav
(D) Aatmanirbhar Bharat

Answer: (B) 150 Years of Vande Mataram

Explanation: The 2026 parade celebrated 150 years of the national song 'Vande Mataram' (composed by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay). Pan-India band performances on the theme were held 19-26 January. The Army also showcased a 'Battle Array Format' for the first time.

Q2. Who were the Chief Guests at the Republic Day 2026 celebrations?

(A) Emmanuel Macron
(B) Prabowo Subianto
(C) Friedrich Merz
(D) Antonio Costa and Ursula von der Leyen

Answer: (D) Antonio Costa and Ursula von der Leyen

Explanation: Antonio Costa (President, European Council) and Ursula von der Leyen (President, European Commission) were the Chief Guests. The 2025 Chief Guest was Indonesia's Prabowo Subianto. They also co-led the India-EU Summit on 27 January.

Q3. Which State/UT tableau won first place at the Republic Day Parade 2026?

(A) Kerala
(B) Gujarat
(C) Maharashtra
(D) Jammu & Kashmir

Answer: (C) Maharashtra

Explanation: Maharashtra won with 'Ganeshotsav: A Symbol of Aatmanirbharta'; Jammu & Kashmir was second and Kerala (Water Metro and 100% digital literacy) third. Ministry of Culture won among central ministries; Gujarat won the MyGov 'Popular Choice' award.

Q4. Which contingents were adjudged the Best Marching Contingents among the three Services and among CAPFs/other auxiliary forces respectively at Republic Day 2026?

(A) Army and CRPF
(B) Indian Navy and Delhi Police
(C) Air Force and BSF
(D) Army and Delhi Police

Answer: (B) Indian Navy and Delhi Police

Explanation: Indian Navy (Services) and Delhi Police (CAPF/auxiliary forces) won the judged awards. In the online Popular Choice voting, the Assam Regiment and CRPF topped their categories.

Q5. The 'Somnath Swabhiman Parv' (8-11 January 2026) commemorated which milestone?

(A) 1,000 years since the first recorded attack on Somnath temple (1026) by Mahmud of Ghazni
(B) 500 years of the Ram Janmabhoomi movement
(C) 100 years of the RSS
(D) 150 years of the Archaeological Survey of India

Answer: (A) 1,000 years since the first recorded attack on Somnath temple (1026) by Mahmud of Ghazni

Explanation: The Parv marked 1,000 years since Ghazni's first attack in 1026, alongside 75 years since the present temple reopened (11 May 1951). PM Modi visited Somnath (Gujarat) on 10-11 January and led a 'Shaurya Yatra'.

Q6. The Viksit Bharat Young Leaders Dialogue (VBYLD) 2026 was held during:

(A) 9-12 January 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
(B) 12-15 January 2026 at Talkatora Stadium, New Delhi
(C) 20-23 January 2026 at Pragati Maidan
(D) 1-4 February 2026 at Vigyan Bhawan

Answer: (A) 9-12 January 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi

Explanation: VBYLD 2026 (second edition; a restructured National Youth Festival) ran 9-12 January at Bharat Mandapam. PM Modi addressed the concluding session on 12 January, National Youth Day (Swami Vivekananda's birth anniversary).

Q7. The Budget Session of Parliament in 2026 commenced on which date?

(A) 20 January
(B) 28 January
(C) 31 January
(D) 1 February

Answer: (B) 28 January

Explanation: The Budget Session began on 28 January 2026 with the President's address to both Houses. The Economic Survey followed on 29 January and the Union Budget 2026-27 on 1 February. Phase I: 28 Jan-13 Feb; Phase II: 9 Mar-2 Apr.

Q8. The UGC (Promotion of Equity in Higher Education Institutions) Regulations, 2026 were stayed by the Supreme Court on 29 January 2026. Which regulations continue to be in force?

(A) UGC Regulations, 2018
(B) UGC Regulations, 2012
(C) UGC Regulations, 2003
(D) UGC Regulations, 2020

Answer: (B) UGC Regulations, 2012

Explanation: The Court said some provisions of the 2026 Regulations were ambiguous and could be misused, so the 2012 Regulations continue. The 2026 rules required an Equal Opportunity Centre and an Equity Committee in every HEI.

Q9. The 53rd New Delhi World Book Fair 2026, which began on 10 January, was held at:

(A) Pragati Maidan (old halls)
(B) Bharat Mandapam
(C) Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium
(D) Yashobhoomi, Dwarka

Answer: (B) Bharat Mandapam

Explanation: The nine-day fair opened at Bharat Mandapam, inaugurated by Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, with over 1,000 publishers from 35+ countries.

2. International News

Q10. What was the code name of the US military operation of 3 January 2026 in which Venezuelan President Nicolas Maduro was captured?

(A) Operation Southern Spear
(B) Operation Absolute Resolve
(C) Operation Liberty Shield
(D) Operation Eagle Claw

Answer: (B) Operation Absolute Resolve

Explanation: 'Operation Absolute Resolve' targeted Caracas and nearby sites; Maduro and his wife Cilia Flores were flown to New York to face charges. 'Operation Southern Spear' is the broader US anti-drug campaign in the region.

Q11. Who was sworn in as Venezuela's acting president on 5 January 2026 after Maduro's capture?

(A) Maria Corina Machado
(B) Diosdado Cabello
(C) Delcy Rodriguez
(D) Vladimir Padrino Lopez

Answer: (C) Delcy Rodriguez

Explanation: Vice-President Delcy Rodriguez assumed power under Venezuelan law and was sworn in as acting president on 5 January 2026.

Q12. Which country became the 21st member of the Eurozone on 1 January 2026?

(A) Romania
(B) Bulgaria
(C) Croatia
(D) Hungary

Answer: (B) Bulgaria

Explanation: Bulgaria replaced the lev with the euro (fixed rate EUR 1 = 1.95583 lev). The euro became sole legal tender from 1 February 2026. Croatia (2023) was the 20th member. The ECB is headquartered in Frankfurt.

Q13. On 22 January 2026, the United States formally withdrew from which international organisation?

(A) World Trade Organization
(B) UNESCO
(C) World Health Organization
(D) International Monetary Fund

Answer: (C) World Health Organization

Explanation: The withdrawal followed Executive Order 14155 (January 2025) and a one-year notice period. WHO is headquartered in Geneva; its Director-General is Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus.

Q14. The charter of the 'Board of Peace' was signed on 22 January 2026 on the sidelines of which event?

(A) UN General Assembly
(B) G7 Summit
(C) World Economic Forum, Davos
(D) BRICS Summit

Answer: (C) World Economic Forum, Davos

Explanation: US President Donald Trump launched the Board of Peace at Davos. It is linked to the Gaza peace plan, whose second phase began on 14 January. Several countries, including France, Norway and Sweden, declined invitations.

Q15. The India-EU Free Trade Agreement concluded on 27 January 2026 creates a free-trade zone of about 2 billion people covering roughly what share of global GDP?

(A) 10%
(B) 25%
(C) 40%
(D) 50%

Answer: (B) 25%

Explanation: Ursula von der Leyen called it the 'mother of all deals'. It covers ~25% of world GDP and about one-third of world trade. As per PRS, it offers market access for 99% of India's exports by value to the EU; negotiations took nearly two decades.

Q16. In January 2026 (29 Jan), the European Union designated which entity as a terrorist organisation?

(A) Hezbollah's political wing
(B) Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) of Iran
(C) Muslim Brotherhood
(D) Taliban

Answer: (B) Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) of Iran

Explanation: The EU listed Iran's IRGC after Tehran's violent crackdown on protests. Iran's foreign minister's Davos invitation had also been revoked.

Q17. Renewed US interest in acquiring Greenland triggered 'Hands off Greenland' protests on 17 January 2026. Greenland is an autonomous territory of which country?

(A) Norway
(B) Iceland
(C) Denmark
(D) Canada

Answer: (C) Denmark

Explanation: Greenland, the world's largest non-continental island, is an autonomous territory of the Kingdom of Denmark, located between the Arctic and Atlantic Oceans.

Q18. During whose state visit to India (12-13 January 2026) was visa-free transit through Germany announced for Indian passport holders?

(A) Olaf Scholz
(B) Friedrich Merz
(C) Emmanuel Macron
(D) Keir Starmer

Answer: (B) Friedrich Merz

Explanation: German Chancellor Friedrich Merz visited on 12-13 Jan; India and Germany signed declarations of intent on industrial defence, semiconductors and critical minerals, plus MoUs in energy, IT and health.

Q19. An LoI to establish a 'Strategic Defence Partnership Framework Agreement' was signed during the 19 January 2026 state visit of which leader?

(A) Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman
(B) UAE President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan
(C) Qatar Emir Tamim bin Hamad Al Thani
(D) Oman Sultan Haitham bin Tariq

Answer: (B) UAE President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan

Explanation: The UAE visit also yielded a 10-year HPCL-ADNOC LNG deal (from 2028), an LoI on the Dholera Special Investment Zone and a target of doubling bilateral trade to over US$ 200 billion by 2032.

3. Government Schemes, Policy & Economy

Q20. Which Act, described in the President's address of 28 January 2026, replaced MGNREGA and guarantees 125 days of rural employment?

(A) Viksit Bharat G RAM G Act
(B) Rozgar Guarantee Act 2025
(C) PM Gramin Rozgar Act
(D) Antyodaya Employment Act

Answer: (A) Viksit Bharat G RAM G Act

Explanation: The Viksit Bharat G RAM G Act replaced MGNREGA (which guaranteed 100 days). The address also noted that dozens of labour laws were consolidated into four Labour Codes.

Q21. The Union Cabinet on 21 January 2026 approved continuation of the Atal Pension Yojana (APY) up to which financial year?

(A) 2027-28
(B) 2028-29
(C) 2030-31
(D) 2035-36

Answer: (C) 2030-31

Explanation: APY (launched May 2015 for unorganised-sector workers) continues till 2030-31 with gap funding and promotional support. Subscribers exceeded 8.66 crore as of 19 January 2026.

Q22. Under APY, the guaranteed minimum monthly pension from age 60 ranges between:

(A) Rs 500 - Rs 2,500
(B) Rs 1,000 - Rs 5,000
(C) Rs 2,000 - Rs 10,000
(D) Rs 3,000 - Rs 15,000

Answer: (B) Rs 1,000 - Rs 5,000

Explanation: The pension of Rs 1,000-5,000 per month depends on the contribution made. APY is administered by PFRDA.

Q23. As per the First Advance Estimates released by MoSPI on 7 January 2026, India's real GDP growth for 2025-26 is estimated at:

(A) 6.5%
(B) 7.0%
(C) 7.4%
(D) 8.2%

Answer: (C) 7.4%

Explanation: FAE puts 2025-26 growth at 7.4% (6.5% in 2024-25), with GVA at 7.3%. Financial and public services lead at 9.9% each. 8.2% was the Q2 FY26 growth.

Q24. The Economic Survey 2025-26 projects real GDP growth for FY27 in the range of:

(A) 6.3-6.8%
(B) 6.8-7.2%
(C) 7.5-8.0%
(D) 5.5-6.0%

Answer: (B) 6.8-7.2%

Explanation: The Survey (tabled 29 January 2026 by FM Nirmala Sitharaman; CEA V. Anantha Nageswaran) projects 6.8-7.2% for FY27 and raised India's potential growth to ~7% (from 6.5%). The 6.3-6.8% range was the previous year's projection.

Q25. The Economic Survey 2025-26 was tabled in Parliament on:

(A) 28 January 2026
(B) 29 January 2026
(C) 30 January 2026
(D) 1 February 2026

Answer: (B) 29 January 2026

Explanation: It was tabled on Thursday, 29 January 2026, a few days ahead of the Union Budget 2026-27 (1 February). The Survey estimated FY26 growth at 7.4% and CPI inflation at 1.7%.

Q26. CPI inflation averaged about how much in Q3 (October-December) of 2025-26?

(A) 0.76%
(B) 1.71%
(C) 4.60%
(D) 5.64%

Answer: (A) 0.76%

Explanation: CPI inflation was 0.76% in Q3 FY26 (5.64% a year earlier); food inflation was -3.88%. Q2 inflation was 1.71%. WPI inflation was -0.17%.

Q27. National Startup Day, marking 10 years of Startup India in 2026, is observed on:

(A) 10 January
(B) 12 January
(C) 16 January
(D) 25 January

Answer: (C) 16 January

Explanation: Startup India was launched on 16 January 2016 (DPIIT); the day was designated National Startup Day in 2022. DPIIT had recognised over 2 lakh startups by December 2025, with ~45% having a woman director/partner.

Q28. Under the National Sports Governance (National Sports Bodies) Rules, 2026, the general body of a National Sports Body must include at least how many 'Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit' (SOM)?

(A) Two
(B) Four
(C) Six
(D) Eight

Answer: (B) Four

Explanation: At least four SOM, half of them women, framed under the National Sports Governance Act, 2025. SOM must be Indian citizens, 25+ years and retired from active sport.

Q29. The Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026 (notified 27 January 2026) come into effect from:

(A) 1 January 2026
(B) 1 April 2026
(C) 1 July 2026
(D) 2 October 2026

Answer: (B) 1 April 2026

Explanation: They replace the 2016 Rules from 1 April 2026, extend to rural local bodies, widen 'bulk waste generator' to include entities with 20,000 sq m floor area or 40,000 litres/day water use and cover residential societies.

Q30. In January 2026, the Greenhouse Gases Emission Intensity Target Rules (under the Carbon Credit Trading Scheme, 2023) were extended to four additional industries. Which of these is one of them?

(A) Fertilisers
(B) Thermal power
(C) Petroleum refineries
(D) Sugar

Answer: (C) Petroleum refineries

Explanation: The four added sectors are secondary aluminium, petroleum refineries, petrochemicals and textiles.

Q31. The Environment (Protection) Fund Rules, 2026 provide that penalties under which Acts will be credited to the Fund?

(A) Air Act, Water Act and Environment (Protection) Act
(B) Forest Conservation Act and Wildlife Act
(C) Biodiversity Act and Forest Rights Act
(D) Coastal Regulation and EIA rules

Answer: (A) Air Act, Water Act and Environment (Protection) Act

Explanation: Penalties under the Air (1981), Water (1974) and Environment (Protection) Act (1986) go to the Fund, used for monitoring equipment, labs, clean-tech research and remediation; admin cost capped at 5%.

Q32. The RBI discussion paper of 13 January 2026 on licensing of Urban Co-operative Banks (UCBs) proposed minimum capital of:

(A) Rs 100 crore
(B) Rs 200 crore
(C) Rs 300 crore
(D) Rs 500 crore

Answer: (C) Rs 300 crore

Explanation: Proposed eligibility: Rs 300 crore capital, 10 years of operations, CRAR of 12%+ and net NPA under 3%. RBI had paused new UCB licensing in 2004; 1,457 UCBs were operational at March 2025.

Q33. The draft Pesticide Management Bill, 2025 (released January 2026) seeks to replace which law?

(A) Insecticides Act, 1968
(B) Agricultural Produce Act, 1937
(C) Essential Commodities Act, 1955
(D) Fertiliser Control Order, 1985

Answer: (A) Insecticides Act, 1968

Explanation: It proposes a Central Pesticides Board and a Registration Committee and would replace the Insecticides Act, 1968 and Insecticides Rules, 1971.

4. Government Appointments

Q34. Who was elected national president of the BJP on 20 January 2026, succeeding J.P. Nadda?

(A) Bhupender Yadav
(B) Nitin Nabin
(C) Sunil Bansal
(D) Vinod Tawde

Answer: (B) Nitin Nabin

Explanation: Nitin Nabin (five-time Bihar MLA) was named working president in December 2025 and elected unopposed president on 20 January 2026 - the youngest BJP president.

Q35. Nitin Nabin is the first BJP national president from which state?

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Bihar
(C) Gujarat
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Answer: (B) Bihar

Explanation: He is the first BJP president from Bihar. The Returning Officer was Dr K. Laxman.

Q36. Who took charge as Director General of the National Investigation Agency (NIA) on 15 January 2026?

(A) Sadanand Date
(B) Rakesh Aggarwal
(C) Praveen Kumar
(D) Yogesh Chander Modi

Answer: (B) Rakesh Aggarwal

Explanation: IPS officer Rakesh Aggarwal (also spelt Agrawal) succeeded Sadanand Date, whose term ended on 2 January 2026; Aggarwal acted in between.

Q37. Who was appointed Director General of the Border Security Force (BSF) on 14 January 2026?

(A) Shatrujeet Singh Kapoor
(B) Praveen Kumar
(C) Daljit Singh Chaudhary
(D) Nitin Agrawal

Answer: (B) Praveen Kumar

Explanation: Praveen Kumar (1993-batch IPS, West Bengal cadre; tenure till 30 September 2030) moved from ITBP to BSF; Shatrujeet Singh Kapoor became the new ITBP DG.

Q38. Who was sworn in as Maharashtra's Deputy Chief Minister on 31 January 2026, becoming the first woman to hold the post?

(A) Supriya Sule
(B) Sunetra Pawar
(C) Pankaja Munde
(D) Aditi Tatkare

Answer: (B) Sunetra Pawar

Explanation: Rajya Sabha MP Sunetra Pawar filled the vacancy caused by Ajit Pawar's death; she was elected NCP national president on 26 February 2026.

5. Awards & Honours

Q39. How many Padma Awards were announced for 2026 (5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan, 113 Padma Shri)?

(A) 120
(B) 125
(C) 131
(D) 139

Answer: (C) 131

Explanation: 131 awards were announced on 25 January 2026 - 19 women, 6 foreigners/NRIs/PIOs/OCIs and 16 posthumous awardees.

Q40. Which of the following was NOT a Padma Vibhushan recipient in 2026?

(A) K.T. Thomas
(B) N. Rajam
(C) Mammootty
(D) P. Narayanan

Answer: (C) Mammootty

Explanation: The five Padma Vibhushan awardees: Dharmendra (posthumous), V.S. Achuthanandan (posthumous), K.T. Thomas, N. Rajam and P. Narayanan. Mammootty received the Padma Bhushan, as did Alka Yagnik, Uday Kotak, Vijay Amritraj and Shibu Soren (posthumous).

Q41. Which cricketer was honoured with a Padma Shri in 2026?

(A) Virat Kohli
(B) Rohit Sharma
(C) Jasprit Bumrah
(D) Ravindra Jadeja

Answer: (B) Rohit Sharma

Explanation: Rohit Sharma and Harmanpreet Kaur received Padma Shri, along with Savita Punia (hockey) and para-athlete Praveen Kumar.

Q42. Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla was conferred which gallantry award on Republic Day 2026, for his role in the Axiom-4 mission?

(A) Kirti Chakra
(B) Shaurya Chakra
(C) Param Vir Chakra
(D) Ashoka Chakra

Answer: (D) Ashoka Chakra

Explanation: The Ashoka Chakra is India's highest peacetime gallantry award. Awards for 70 personnel included 1 Ashoka Chakra, 3 Kirti Chakras and 13 Shaurya Chakras. He was the first Indian on the ISS.

Q43. The Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament and Development 2025 was awarded to:

(A) Graca Machel
(B) Michelle Bachelet
(C) Angela Merkel
(D) Malala Yousafzai

Answer: (A) Graca Machel

Explanation: Mozambican humanitarian Graca Machel won it (announced 21 January 2026; jury chaired by Shivshankar Menon). The prize carries Rs 1 crore. Michelle Bachelet won the 2024 prize.

Q44. Which film won Best Motion Picture - Drama at the 83rd Golden Globe Awards (11 January 2026)?

(A) One Battle After Another
(B) Sinners
(C) Hamnet
(D) The Secret Agent

Answer: (C) Hamnet

Explanation: 'Hamnet' (Chloe Zhao) won, with Jessie Buckley as Best Actress (Drama). 'One Battle After Another' won Best Musical/Comedy plus Director and Screenplay for Paul Thomas Anderson.

Q45. Which new category was introduced for the first time at the 83rd Golden Globes?

(A) Best Stunt Design
(B) Best Podcast
(C) Best Short Film
(D) Best Casting

Answer: (B) Best Podcast

Explanation: Best Podcast debuted; Amy Poehler's 'Good Hang' won. Wagner Moura (Brazil) won Best Actor (Drama) for 'The Secret Agent'.

6. Important Reports, Rankings & Indexes

Q46. Which risk was ranked the top global risk for 2026 in the World Economic Forum's Global Risks Report 2026 (21st edition, released 14 January)?

(A) Extreme weather events
(B) Misinformation and disinformation
(C) Geoeconomic confrontation
(D) Cyber insecurity

Answer: (C) Geoeconomic confrontation

Explanation: Geoeconomic confrontation topped both the 2026 and two-year rankings (up eight places), followed by state-based armed conflict, extreme weather, societal polarisation and misinformation.

Q47. In the Global Risks Report 2026, which category of risk dominates the 10-year (long-term) outlook?

(A) Technological risks
(B) Economic risks
(C) Societal risks
(D) Environmental risks

Answer: (D) Environmental risks

Explanation: Environmental risks (led by extreme weather events) dominate the long-term horizon, though they slipped in short-term rankings.

Q48. Which country's passport topped the Henley Passport Index released in January 2026, with visa-free access to 192 destinations?

(A) Japan
(B) South Korea
(C) Singapore
(D) UAE

Answer: (C) Singapore

Explanation: Singapore retained first place; Japan, South Korea and the UAE followed. Afghanistan ranked last. The index uses IATA data and covers 199 passports and 227 destinations.

Q49. India's rank in the January 2026 edition of the Henley Passport Index (55 destinations) was:

(A) 75th
(B) 80th
(C) 85th
(D) 101st

Answer: (B) 80th

Explanation: India rose to 80th (from 85th in 2025), tied with Algeria. Later 2026 editions reported different ranks, so always note the edition date in exams.

7. Sports

Q50. Virat Kohli overtook which player on 11 January 2026 to become the second-highest run-scorer in international cricket?

(A) Ricky Ponting
(B) Jacques Kallis
(C) Kumar Sangakkara
(D) Rahul Dravid

Answer: (C) Kumar Sangakkara

Explanation: Kohli passed Sangakkara's 28,016 runs during a 93 in the 1st ODI vs New Zealand at Vadodara. Sachin Tendulkar leads with 34,357.

Q51. What was the result of the January 2026 ODI series between India and New Zealand?

(A) India won 2-1
(B) India won 3-0
(C) New Zealand won 2-1
(D) Drawn 1-1

Answer: (C) New Zealand won 2-1

Explanation: New Zealand won 2-1 - their first ODI series win in India. Daryl Mitchell was the leading run-scorer (352).

Q52. Who scored a maiden T20I century in the 5th T20I vs New Zealand at Thiruvananthapuram (31 January 2026), which India won 4-1 in the series?

(A) Abhishek Sharma
(B) Suryakumar Yadav
(C) Ishan Kishan
(D) Shivam Dube

Answer: (C) Ishan Kishan

Explanation: Ishan Kishan made 103 off 43 balls; India scored 271/5 and won by 46 runs. Arshdeep Singh took his first T20I five-wicket haul.

Q53. Which team replaced Bangladesh in Group C of the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026 on 24 January 2026?

(A) Namibia
(B) Scotland
(C) Ireland
(D) Netherlands

Answer: (B) Scotland

Explanation: Bangladesh refused to play in India over security concerns; the ICC found no credible threat and picked Scotland (next-highest ranked non-qualifier). The tournament is co-hosted by India and Sri Lanka from 7 February.

Q54. Who won the women's singles title at the 2026 Australian Open (final on 31 January)?

(A) Aryna Sabalenka
(B) Madison Keys
(C) Iga Swiatek
(D) Elena Rybakina

Answer: (D) Elena Rybakina

Explanation: Elena Rybakina (Kazakhstan) beat Aryna Sabalenka 6-4, 4-6, 6-4 for her second Grand Slam. Venus Williams (45 years 7 months) became the oldest woman to play the singles main draw.

Q55. Who scored the first-ever century in the Women's Premier League on 26 January 2026?

(A) Smriti Mandhana
(B) Harmanpreet Kaur
(C) Nat Sciver-Brunt
(D) Meg Lanning

Answer: (C) Nat Sciver-Brunt

Explanation: Nat Sciver-Brunt (Mumbai Indians) made 100* off 57 balls against RCB at Vadodara, in the 82nd WPL match. RCB won the 2026 title.

Q56. Saina Nehwal, who confirmed her retirement in January 2026, won an Olympic bronze medal at which Games?

(A) Beijing 2008
(B) London 2012
(C) Rio 2016
(D) Tokyo 2020

Answer: (B) London 2012

Explanation: She was India's first Olympic badminton medallist (London 2012) and World No. 1 in 2015. She last played at the 2023 Singapore Open; chronic knee arthritis ended her career.

Q57. Who won the mixed doubles title at the 2026 Australian Open, becoming the first pair in 37 years to defend the crown?

(A) Olivia Gadecki and John Peers
(B) Kristina Mladenovic and Manuel Guinard
(C) Nick Kyrgios and Leylah Fernandez
(D) Elise Mertens and Zhang Shuai

Answer: (A) Olivia Gadecki and John Peers

Explanation: Gadecki/Peers beat Mladenovic/Guinard 4-6, 6-3, [10-8]. Mertens/Zhang won the women's doubles.

8. Defence

Q58. The 78th Army Day parade (15 January 2026) was held in which city, the first time outside a military cantonment on a public route?

(A) Pune
(B) Lucknow
(C) Jaipur
(D) Bengaluru

Answer: (C) Jaipur

Explanation: Held on Mahal Road, Jagatpura (Jaipur). Earlier parades outside Delhi: Bengaluru 2023, Lucknow 2024, Pune 2025. Army Day marks Gen K.M. Cariappa becoming the first Indian Commander-in-Chief on 15 January 1949.

Q59. The Indian Army declared 2026 as the:

(A) Year of Reforms
(B) Year of Networking and Data Centricity
(C) Year of Jointness
(D) Year of Technology Absorption

Answer: (B) Year of Networking and Data Centricity

Explanation: The theme focuses on digitalisation, AI, cyber resilience and data-driven decision-making. (2025 was the Year of Reforms; 2024 'Year of Technology Absorption'.)

Q60. Which formation did the Indian Army showcase for the first time at the Republic Day 2026 parade?

(A) Battle Array Format
(B) Drone Swarm Column
(C) Bhishma Cube
(D) Rudra Brigade

Answer: (A) Battle Array Format

Explanation: The Army displayed a 'Battle Array Format' for the first time, with 18 marching contingents and 13 bands.

9. Science & Technology, Space, ISRO, DRDO & Discoveries

Q61. ISRO's PSLV-C62 mission (EOS-N1) of 12 January 2026 failed due to an anomaly in which stage?

(A) First stage (PS1)
(B) Second stage (PS2)
(C) Third stage (PS3)
(D) Fourth stage (PS4)

Answer: (C) Third stage (PS3)

Explanation: Performance was normal until near the end of PS3, where roll-rate disturbances caused a flight-path deviation. It was the 64th PSLV flight and the second consecutive PSLV failure. ISRO Chairman: V. Narayanan.

Q62. The primary payload of PSLV-C62, EOS-N1 ('Anvesha'), is a hyperspectral Earth-imaging satellite developed by:

(A) ISRO
(B) DRDO
(C) NRSC
(D) HAL

Answer: (B) DRDO

Explanation: EOS-N1 was DRDO-developed for surveillance and infrastructure monitoring; the mission was run by NewSpace India Limited (NSIL).

Q63. Which Hyderabad-based private company contributed seven satellites to PSLV-C62, a first for a single Indian firm?

(A) Pixxel
(B) Agnikul Cosmos
(C) Dhruva Space
(D) Digantara

Answer: (C) Dhruva Space

Explanation: Dhruva Space supplied seven of the co-passenger satellites, which were lost. The Orbital Paradigm 'KID' re-entry capsule reportedly survived and sent data for ~190 seconds.

Q64. DRDL's January 2026 ground test of an actively cooled scramjet combustor, a step towards hypersonic cruise missiles, ran for over:

(A) 2 minutes
(B) 5 minutes
(C) 12 minutes
(D) 30 minutes

Answer: (C) 12 minutes

Explanation: The 12+ minute test (9 January, SCPT facility, Hyderabad) builds on an April 2025 subscale test. Hypersonic missiles fly above Mach 5 (over ~6,100 km/h).

Q65. The third-generation fire-and-forget Man-Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile (MPATGM) with top-attack capability, tested on 11 January 2026 at KK Ranges, Ahilyanagar, was developed by:

(A) DRDL, Hyderabad
(B) RCI, Hyderabad
(C) ADE, Bengaluru
(D) VRDE, Ahilyanagar

Answer: (A) DRDL, Hyderabad

Explanation: Developed by DRDO's Defence Research & Development Laboratory (DRDL); the target system came from the Defence Laboratory, Jodhpur. It uses an IIR seeker for day-night operation.

Q66. The January 2026 return of NASA's SpaceX Crew-11 from the ISS was historic because it was:

(A) The first all-private crew return
(B) The first early return for a medical reason in ISS history
(C) The longest ISS mission ever
(D) The first night-time splashdown in the Atlantic

Answer: (B) The first early return for a medical reason in ISS history

Explanation: NASA ended the mission about a month early after a crew member's medical issue; the Dragon splashed down off California on 15 January after 167 days. The affected astronaut was not named.

Q67. Crew-11 member Kimiya Yui belongs to which space agency?

(A) NASA
(B) ESA
(C) JAXA
(D) Roscosmos

Answer: (C) JAXA

Explanation: Yui is a JAXA astronaut. Other crew: Zena Cardman and Mike Fincke (NASA) and Oleg Platonov (Roscosmos).

Q68. Hubble's January 2026 'Cloud-9' discovery is described as:

(A) A rogue planet
(B) A starless, gas-rich dark-matter cloud - a relic of early galaxy formation
(C) A binary pulsar
(D) A new moon of Saturn

Answer: (B) A starless, gas-rich dark-matter cloud - a relic of early galaxy formation

Explanation: Announced 5 January 2026 - the first confirmed detection of this new type of astronomical object. On 27 January an AI-assisted search of the Hubble archive found ~1,400 anomalous objects.

Q69. Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla became the first Indian to visit the ISS aboard which mission?

(A) Gaganyaan G1
(B) Axiom-4
(C) Crew-11
(D) Soyuz MS-27

Answer: (B) Axiom-4

Explanation: Axiom Mission-4 (NASA-Axiom Space collaboration, mid-2025). He was awarded the Ashoka Chakra in January 2026.

10. IMD, Climate & Environment

Q70. According to IMD's 'Statement on the Climate of India during 2025', 2025 was the ___ warmest year since 1901.

(A) Warmest
(B) Fourth
(C) Eighth
(D) Twelfth

Answer: (C) Eighth

Explanation: Annual mean land temperature was +0.28 C above the 1991-2020 average. The decade 2016-2025 was the warmest on record, and 10 of the 15 warmest years fall in 2011-2025.

Q71. Which year remains India's warmest on record (anomaly +0.65 C)?

(A) 2016
(B) 2023
(C) 2024
(D) 2025

Answer: (C) 2024

Explanation: 2024 is the warmest since 1901; 2016 is the next. IMD recorded at least 2,760 weather-related deaths in 2025.

Q72. India's January-February 2025 winter season anomaly of +1.17 C was:

(A) Coolest in 50 years
(B) Near normal
(C) The warmest winter since 1901
(D) The driest winter on record

Answer: (C) The warmest winter since 1901

Explanation: It was the warmest winter in 124 years. February 2025 recorded the highest monthly minimum temperature anomaly ever.

Q73. The India Meteorological Department (IMD), which celebrated its 151st Foundation Day on 15 January 2026, was established in:

(A) 1857
(B) 1875
(C) 1901
(D) 1947

Answer: (B) 1875

Explanation: IMD was founded on 15 January 1875 (HQ then Calcutta; now Mausam Bhawan, New Delhi) under the Ministry of Earth Sciences. Mission Mausam was launched on 14 January 2025; 47 Doppler radars cover ~87% of India's area.

Q74. The second nationwide estimation of riverine and estuarine dolphins under Project Dolphin was flagged off by Union Minister Bhupender Yadav from:

(A) Patna
(B) Bijnor (Uttar Pradesh)
(C) Guwahati
(D) Kolkata

Answer: (B) Bijnor (Uttar Pradesh)

Explanation: It was launched from Bijnor, on the Ganga. The Ganges river dolphin is India's National Aquatic Animal.

11. Summits & International Organisations

Q75. What was the theme of the 56th World Economic Forum Annual Meeting at Davos (19-23 January 2026)?

(A) Rebuilding Trust
(B) A Spirit of Dialogue
(C) Cooperation in a Fragmented World
(D) Intelligent Age

Answer: (B) A Spirit of Dialogue

Explanation: Davos 2026 ran under 'A Spirit of Dialogue' with five priorities including cooperation in a contested world, innovation at scale and growth within planetary boundaries.

Q76. Which UN agency leads the International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists, declared for 2026?

(A) UNEP
(B) FAO
(C) UNESCO
(D) UNDP

Answer: (B) FAO

Explanation: FAO leads both this Year and the International Year of the Woman Farmer; the rangelands proposal was led by Mongolia. 2026 is also the International Year of Volunteers for Sustainable Development.

Q77. Antonio Costa, who co-led the India-EU Summit on 27 January 2026, is the President of the:

(A) European Parliament
(B) European Commission
(C) European Council
(D) European Central Bank

Answer: (C) European Council

Explanation: Costa heads the European Council; Ursula von der Leyen heads the European Commission; Roberta Metsola leads the Parliament; Christine Lagarde the ECB.

12. Important Days

Q78. World Braille Day, observed on 4 January, commemorates the birth anniversary of Louis Braille, born in:

(A) 1789
(B) 1809
(C) 1829
(D) 1849

Answer: (B) 1809

Explanation: Louis Braille was born on 4 January 1809. The UN started observing World Braille Day in 2019.

Q79. Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (9 January) marks the day on which:

(A) Netaji formed the INA
(B) Mahatma Gandhi returned to India from South Africa (1915)
(C) India joined the UN
(D) Swami Vivekananda spoke at Chicago

Answer: (B) Mahatma Gandhi returned to India from South Africa (1915)

Explanation: PBD commemorates Gandhi's return to Bombay on 9 January 1915.

Q80. World Hindi Day is observed on:

(A) 10 January
(B) 14 September
(C) 5 January
(D) 26 January

Answer: (A) 10 January

Explanation: Observed on 10 January since 2006 (first World Hindi Conference, Nagpur, 1975). Hindi Diwas is on 14 September.

Q81. Parakram Diwas (23 January) commemorates the birth anniversary of:

(A) Bhagat Singh
(B) Subhas Chandra Bose
(C) Lala Lajpat Rai
(D) Chandrashekhar Azad

Answer: (B) Subhas Chandra Bose

Explanation: Declared in 2021; 2026 marked Netaji's 129th birth anniversary (born 1897).

Q82. National Girl Child Day, observed on 24 January, was started in which year?

(A) 2000
(B) 2005
(C) 2008
(D) 2015

Answer: (C) 2008

Explanation: Started by the Ministry of Women and Child Development in 2008. (Beti Bachao Beti Padhao launched in 2015.)

Q83. The 16th National Voters' Day on 25 January 2026 had which theme?

(A) Nothing Like Voting, I Vote for Sure
(B) My India, My Vote
(C) Proud to be a First-Time Voter
(D) Inclusive and Participative Elections

Answer: (B) My India, My Vote

Explanation: Theme: 'My India, My Vote' (tagline: Citizen at the Heart of Indian Democracy). It marks the ECI's foundation on 25 January 1950 (observed since 2011). President Murmu was Chief Guest; CEC is Gyanesh Kumar.

Q84. Martyrs' Day (Shaheed Diwas) in India on 30 January commemorates:

(A) Bhagat Singh's execution
(B) Mahatma Gandhi's assassination (1948)
(C) Jallianwala Bagh
(D) Kargil War

Answer: (B) Mahatma Gandhi's assassination (1948)

Explanation: It marks Mahatma Gandhi's assassination on 30 January 1948. (23 March also honours Bhagat Singh, Rajguru and Sukhdev.)

13. Books & Authors

Q85. The second edition of the book 'History That India Ignored' was launched in Goa in January 2026. Who is its author?

(A) Vikram Sampath
(B) Prem Prakash
(C) Sanjeev Sanyal
(D) A. Surya Prakash

Answer: (B) Prem Prakash

Explanation: Written by veteran journalist Prem Prakash; launched by Goa CM Pramod Sawant on 5 January 2026 at Panaji (Vitasta Publishing). It covers neglected chapters of the freedom struggle and Goa's liberation.

Q86. Prem Prakash, author of 'History That India Ignored', is Chairman of which news agency?

(A) PTI
(B) UNI
(C) ANI
(D) IANS

Answer: (C) ANI

Explanation: He is Chairman of Asian News International (ANI), which reported the launch.

14. Obituaries

Q87. Maharashtra Deputy CM Ajit Pawar died on 28 January 2026 in a plane crash at:

(A) Pune airport
(B) Baramati airport
(C) Nashik airport
(D) Kolhapur airport

Answer: (B) Baramati airport

Explanation: A Learjet 45 (VT-SSK) crashed while landing at Baramati; all five aboard died. AAIB is investigating. Maharashtra declared three days of state mourning; last rites were on 29 January with state honours.

Q88. How many terms did Ajit Pawar serve as Maharashtra's Deputy Chief Minister, a record?

(A) Three
(B) Four
(C) Five
(D) Six

Answer: (D) Six

Explanation: He was Deputy CM six times, the state's longest-serving, and presented the state budget 11 times. He was 66 and the nephew of Sharad Pawar.

Q89. Ecologist Madhav Gadgil, who died on 7 January 2026 aged 83, chaired which panel (2010)?

(A) National Ganga River Basin Authority
(B) Western Ghats Ecology Expert Panel
(C) Kasturirangan Committee
(D) Wildlife Board Task Force

Answer: (B) Western Ghats Ecology Expert Panel

Explanation: The Gadgil Commission recommended demarcating ecologically sensitive areas in the Western Ghats. He founded the Centre for Ecological Sciences at IISc and held the Padma Shri and Padma Bhushan.

15. Important Personalities

Q90. Who is the Chairman of ISRO, quoted on the PSLV-C62 anomaly?

(A) S. Somanath
(B) K. Sivan
(C) V. Narayanan
(D) A.S. Kiran Kumar

Answer: (C) V. Narayanan

Explanation: Dr V. Narayanan is ISRO Chairman and Secretary, Department of Space.

Q91. Who is the NASA Administrator who announced the early return of Crew-11 in January 2026?

(A) Bill Nelson
(B) Jared Isaacman
(C) Jim Bridenstine
(D) Sean Duffy

Answer: (B) Jared Isaacman

Explanation: Jared Isaacman heads NASA; the decision was announced at a 8 January 2026 news conference.

Q92. Who is India's Chief Economic Adviser, under whom the Economic Survey 2025-26 was prepared?

(A) Arvind Subramanian
(B) V. Anantha Nageswaran
(C) Sanjeev Sanyal
(D) Krishnamurthy Subramanian

Answer: (B) V. Anantha Nageswaran

Explanation: V. Anantha Nageswaran has been CEA since January 2022.

Q93. Who is the Chief Election Commissioner of India who led the National Voters' Day 2026 event?

(A) Rajiv Kumar
(B) Gyanesh Kumar
(C) Sukhbir Singh Sandhu
(D) Vivek Joshi

Answer: (B) Gyanesh Kumar

Explanation: CEC Gyanesh Kumar led the event with ECs Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi.

Q94. Graca Machel, winner of the Indira Gandhi Peace Prize 2025, was married to the first President of which country?

(A) Zimbabwe
(B) Mozambique
(C) Tanzania
(D) Angola

Answer: (B) Mozambique

Explanation: Her first husband Samora Machel was Mozambique's first President; she later married Nelson Mandela. She founded the Graca Machel Trust in 2010.

Quick Answer Key

1: B	**2**: D	**3**: C	**4**: B	**5**: A	**6**: A	**7**: B	**8**: B	**9**: B	**10**: B
11: C	**12**: B	**13**: C	**14**: C	**15**: B	**16**: B	**17**: C	**18**: B	**19**: B	**20**: A
21: C	**22**: B	**23**: C	**24**: B	**25**: B	**26**: A	**27**: C	**28**: B	**29**: B	**30**: C
31: A	**32**: C	**33**: A	**34**: B	**35**: B	**36**: B	**37**: B	**38**: B	**39**: C	**40**: C
41: B	**42**: D	**43**: A	**44**: C	**45**: B	**46**: C	**47**: D	**48**: C	**49**: B	**50**: C
51: C	**52**: C	**53**: B	**54**: D	**55**: C	**56**: B	**57**: A	**58**: C	**59**: B	**60**: A
61: C	**62**: B	**63**: C	**64**: C	**65**: A	**66**: B	**67**: C	**68**: B	**69**: B	**70**: C
71: C	**72**: C	**73**: B	**74**: B	**75**: B	**76**: B	**77**: C	**78**: B	**79**: B	**80**: A
81: B	**82**: C	**83**: B	**84**: B	**85**: B	**86**: C	**87**: B	**88**: D	**89**: B	**90**: C
91: B	**92**: B	**93**: B	**94**: B						

Sources and note: compiled from PIB, All India Radio/Newsonair, PRS Legislative Research, IMD, ISRO/DRDO releases, NASA, WEF, ICC, ESPNcricinfo and major news outlets. Numbers such as rankings can change in later editions - always check the edition date. Please cross-verify key facts with official sources before your exam.